Xinyan Wang

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Personal Website: **https://xinyan-wang-stat.github.io/**
Linkedin: **xinyan-wang-34b462206**

Research Interests

LLM post-training (RL, on-policy distillation), LLM agents and agent red-teaming, efficient inference.

Education

- **University of Wisconsin–Madison** — Madison, WI, USA
  Ph.D. in Statistics; Advisors: Profs. Jun Shao and Xiao Luo — *Sep 2023 – May 2028 (Expected)*
  M.S. in Computer Science — *Sep 2023 – May 2026*
  M.S. in Statistics — *Sep 2022 – May 2023*
  Visiting Student in Statistics and Computer Science — *Sep 2021 – May 2022*
- **East China Normal University** — Shanghai, China
  B.S. in Statistics — *Sep 2018 – June 2022*

Experience

- **SaFo Lab** — Johns Hopkins University
  Research Intern; Mentor: Prof. Chaowei Xiao — *Aug 2025 – Present*
  - Research on safe and efficient large reasoning models and LLM agents.

Publications

Xinyan Wang*, Xiaogeng Liu*, Jun Shao, Chaowei Xiao. *Appreciation Teaches Unauthorized Execution: Self-Evolution Degrades the Robustness of Personal Agents to Indirect Prompt Injection.* Preprint, 2026. arXiv:2610.39122.

Xiaogeng Liu, **Xinyan Wang**, Chaowei Xiao. *FlipJev: Fast Black-Box Red Teaming Finds Universal Adversarial Suffixes for Typed Decision Models.* Preprint, 2026. arXiv:2610.38895.

Xiaogeng Liu, **Xinyan Wang**, Yingzi Ma, Yechao Zhang, Chaowei Xiao. *When Are Teacher Tokens Reliable? Position-Weighted On-Policy Self-Distillation for Reasoning.* NeurIPS 2026 (Poster). arXiv:2605.21606.

Xiaogeng Liu, **Xinyan Wang**, Yechao Zhang, Sanjay Kariyappa, Chong Xiang, Muhao Chen, G. Edward Suh, Chaowei Xiao. *ReasoningBomb: A Stealthy Denial-of-Service Attack by Inducing Pathologically Long Reasoning in Large Reasoning Models.* ACM Conference on Computer and Communications Security (CCS), 2026.

Xinyan Wang, Xiaogeng Liu, Ming Pei, Chaowei Xiao. *ROM: Real-time Overthinking Mitigation via Streaming Detection and Intervention.* Preprint, 2026. arXiv:2603.22016.

Jun Shao, **Xinyan Wang**. *MLE with Datasets from Populations Having Shared Parameters.* Statistical Theory and Related Fields, 7(3):213–222, 2023.

Teaching

STAT 240 (Data Science Modeling I), STAT 309 (Introduction to Probability and Mathematical Statistics I), STAT 340 (Data Science Modeling II), STAT 609 (Introduction to Statistical Inference), STAT 610 (Statistical Inference), STAT 611 (Statistical Models for Data Science), STAT 613 (Statistical Methods for Data Science).

Professional Service

Reviewer: ACL 2026, ECCV 2026, EMNLP 2026, NeurIPS 2026